

Strong 2-♣ Opening

Open 2♣ on any hand containing 22 or more points.

OR, open 2♣ with a hand containing 19-21 points and with 9+ playing tricks.

There are several methods of responding. For these Deals use the 2♦ Negative for all hands with 7 or fewer points. Any other response shows 8 or more points.

The 2♣ bid is artificial; Opener's second bid describes her hand.

2NT shows a balanced 22-24 point hand

3NT shows a balanced 25-27 point hand

2 of a suit shows a 5-card or longer suit

With a very weak hand (0-3 points) Responder should bid the "second negative" at his second turn. This is usually 3♣, but if Opener bids 3♣ then it is 3♦. If Opener should bid 3♦ at his second turn the second negative bid is 3♥.

Later bidding depends on the partnership, but unless particular conventions are in use then later bidding is natural.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Lead: ♥ J

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3♥

Declarer: East

Lead: ♠ 10

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: South

Lead: ♠ J

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 7♠

Declarer: West

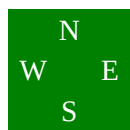
Lead: ♥ 3

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 10 9 3
♥ Q 8 4 2
♦ K J 10 9
♣ 8 2

♠ A J 8 7
♥ A K
♦ A 8 6
♣ A K Q J



♠ K 5 4
♥ J 10 6
♦ 7 4 3
♣ 10 7 6 4

♠ Q 6 2
♥ 9 7 5 3
♦ Q 5 2
♣ 9 5 3

NORTH has lots of points - 26 to be exact. She opens 2♣. In the old days this hand would have been opened 3NT.

SOUTH has 4 points and responds 2♦.

NORTH now shows her full strength by jumping to 3NT (25-27 points, balanced).

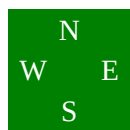
SOUTH knows there is no slam, so he passes 3NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♥J			

Board 2
 East Deals
 N-S Vul

♠ 6 4 2
 ♥ 7 5 4
 ♦ J 7 2
 ♣ 8 6 5 3

♠ K J
 ♥ J 10
 ♦ A Q 9 4
 ♣ J 10 9 7 2



♠ A 7 3
 ♥ A K Q 8 6 2
 ♦ 8 6
 ♣ A K

♠ Q 10 9 8 5
 ♥ 9 3
 ♦ K 10 5 3
 ♣ Q 4

EAST has 22 points and opens 2♣.

WEST is pretty weak, right? She responds 2♦.

EAST bids his suit, 2♥.

WEST is so weak she bids the second negative - 3♣.

EAST rebids his suit, 3♥, and WEST passes.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		2♣	Pass
2♦	Pass	2♥	Pass
3♣	Pass	3♥	
All Pass			
3♥ by East			
Lead: ♠ 10			

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 8 7

♥ 10 4

♦ 9 6 4 3

♣ 8 6 4

♠ A K 6 3

♥ A K 8 2

♦ K Q J

♣ K Q



♠ Q 9 5

♥ 6 3

♦ 10 8 7

♣ A J 10 9 2

♠ 4 2

♥ Q J 9 7 5

♦ A 5 2

♣ 7 5 3

*West**North**East**South*

2♣

Pass

2♥

Pass

4NT

Pass

5♦

Pass

6♥

All Pass

6♥ by South

Lead: ♠J

NORTH has a nice 2♣ opening hand.

With 8 points, SOUTH can make a positive response so he bids his 5-card ♥ suit.

NORTH likes ♥s, knows there are at least 33 points, but needs to make sure the opponents don't have two Aces so she uses Blackwood.

When SOUTH shows one Ace NORTH bids 6♥.

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J 9 8 3

♥ K 7 2

♦ 6

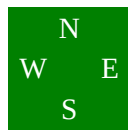
♣ A 8 7 4

♠ 6 5

♥ 9 6 3

♦ Q J 10 7 5

♣ J 3 2



♠ K Q 10 2

♥ A Q J 10 5

♦ A K 2

♣ K

♠ 7 4

♥ 8 4

♦ 9 8 4 3

♣ Q 10 9 6 5

EAST opens 2♣ and is pleased when WEST makes a positive response of 2♠. His first step is to set the trump suit by bidding 3♠. There is NO chance that WEST will pass.

WEST now bids 4♣ a Control-showing bid. EAST continues Control-showing with 4♦.

That's enough for WEST to hear. She invokes Blackwood and learning they have all the Aces bids 7♠.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		2♣	Pass
2♠	Pass	3♠	Pass
4♣	Pass	4♦	Pass
4NT	Pass	5♠	Pass
7♠			
All Pass			
7♠ by West			
Lead: ♥3			